TIPS & TRICKS

Attention please!

Many a time, when working on the computer, we lose track of time and forget to attend to the other important tasks listed in our 'To-Do' list. But now there is a way out! This small script can notify you of these tasks, repeatedly.

Create a script 'notify.sh' with the following command:

```
#/bin/bash
if [ $# -ne 2 ]
      then
         xmessage -default EXIT -center "usage: notify  "
      else
      while true
         do sleep "$1"
         xmessage -default EXIT -center "$2"
         done
fi
```

Now, run the script on the terminal as shown below:

```
vipul@vipul-laptop:~$ nohup ./notify 100 "Complete
Assignment" &
```

By using '&' and 'nohup' we can run the script in the background. Now, we can even close the Terminal without stopping the process that is running in the background.

To stop the reminder, you have to 'kill' the running process or modify the script, which will give you the option to stop it.

—Vipul Vaid, vipul.vid@gmail.com

Eliminate the ' ^ M' character using 'Vi' editor

Sometimes certain characters (e.g., '^M' characters) appear when we convert a file from DOS to UNIX. To remove these '^M' characters, which appear at the end of every line, use the following command in the Vi editor:

```
:%s/^M//g
```

(To type '^M', hold the 'Control' key, press 'V' and then the 'M' key (both while holding the control key), and the character '^M' will appear.)

This command will 'find' all occurrences of the character '^M' and replace them with 'nothing'. Here, the ':%s' denotes the basic search and replace command in the Vi editor. It tells 'Vi' to replace the regular expression between the first and second slashes (^M) with the text between the second and third slashes (nothing, in this case). The 'g' at the end directs the Vi editor to search and replace, globally, all occurrences of the character.

—Abinash Bishoyi, abinash.bishoyi@gmail.com

Combining audio files and extracting a part of it

Given below are the tips that use the 'sox' command to manipulate audio files.

First let's look at how we can combine the two 'wav' audio files using 'sox' on the command line.

```
$ sox -m first_part.wav second_part.wav whole_part.wav
```

With the '-m' flag, 'sox' adds two input files together to produce its output. The example above adds 'first_part.wav' and 'second_part.wav' resulting in 'whole_part.wav'.

The second tip explains how to extract part of the audio file. To do this, use the 'trim' option. Shown below is the syntax and an example.

```
Syntax: sox old.wav new.wav trim [SECOND TO START] [SECONDS
DURATION].
```

Where:

- SECOND TO START is the starting point in the voice file.